

OpenClaw Multi-Agent System

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1. Course Content

Course Overview

- The OpenClaw multi-Agent feature allows running multiple **isolated agents** in the same Gateway. Each agent has its own workspace, state directory, and session history
- The multi-Agent architecture is suitable for multi-role division scenarios. For example, one agent is responsible for programming development while another handles social media operations, with data isolated from each other and no mutual interference

Learning Objectives

1. Understand the concept and applicable scenarios of the OpenClaw multi-Agent system
2. Master creating new agents through CLI commands
3. Master the method of editing agent prompt files (AGENTS.md / SOUL.md / IDENTITY.md, etc.)
4. Master the operation of deleting agents

2. Case Demo

OpenClaw runs one agent by default (agentId is `main`). Additional isolated agents can be created in the following ways.

2.1 Creating with the CLI Agent Wizard

For example, create a work agent named `work`:

```
openclaw agents add work
```

```
┌ Add OpenClaw agent
└
  ◊ Workspace directory
    /home/jetson/.openclaw/workspace-work
  ◆ Configure model/auth for this agent now?
    ○ Yes / ● No
└

◊ Configure chat channels now?
No
Config overwrite: /home/jetson/.openclaw/openclaw.json (sha256 3e306a951df992393f7a2a0d87ba5ed9088ae64fbd4e29088ffab161cb3f14c -> 99fd93a1f06e53e77f20deecc6cc29fc2f7234a94c030919a80f391aea98af03, backup=/home/jetson/.openclaw/openclaw.json.bak)
Updated ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Workspace OK: ~/.openclaw/workspace-work
Sessions OK: ~/.openclaw/agents/work/sessions
Agent "work" ready.
```

After execution, OpenClaw automatically completes the following operations:

1. Create the agent directory: `~/.openclaw/agents/<agentId>/`
2. Create workspace bootstrap files: including `AGENTS.md`, `SOUL.md`, `IDENTITY.md`, `TOOLS.md`, `USER.md`, etc.

2.2 Agent Directory Structure

After each agent is created, a complete file structure is generated in the `~/.openclaw/agents/<agentId>/` directory:

```
~/.openclaw/agents/<agentId>/
├─ agent/
│   ├─ auth-profiles.json    # Authentication profile file
│   ├─ config.json          # Agent configuration
│   └─ ...
├─ sessions/                # Session history storage
│   └─ <SessionId>.json1
```

The agent's workspace files are located in their respective workspace directories, where you can edit the bootstrap files to define the agent's behavior and personality.

2.3 Verifying Agent Creation

After creation, you can view all agents and their binding status with the following command:

```
openclaw agents list --bindings
```

```

Agents:
- main (default)
  Workspace: ~/.openclaw/workspace
  Agent dir: ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
  Model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
  Routing rules: 1
  Routing: Feishu default
  Providers:
    - Feishu default: configured
  Routing rules:
    - feishu accountId=default
- work
  Workspace: ~/.openclaw/workspace-work
  Agent dir: ~/.openclaw/agents/work/agent
  Model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
  Routing rules: 0
Routing rules map channel/account/peer to an agent. Use --bindings for full rules.
Channel status reflects local config/creds. For live health: openclaw channels status --probe.

```

2.4 Restarting the Gateway for the Configuration to Take Effect

After creating an agent or modifying the binding configuration, you need to restart the Gateway:

```
openclaw gateway restart
```

After restarting, verify the agent and channel status:

```
openclaw agents list --bindings
```

```

yahboom@yahboom:~$ openclaw agents list --bindings

♥ OpenClaw 2026.3.13 (61d171a) – Welcome to the command line: where dreams compile and confidence segfaults.

Agents:
- main (default)
  Workspace: ~/.openclaw/workspace
  Agent dir: ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
  Model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
  Routing rules: 0
  Routing: default (no explicit rules)
- work
  Workspace: ~/.openclaw/workspace-work
  Agent dir: ~/.openclaw/agents/work/agent
  Model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
  Routing rules: 0
Routing rules map channel/account/peer to an agent. Use --bindings for full rules.
Channel status reflects local config/creds. For live health: openclaw channels status --probe.

```

2.5 Agent Conversation

```
openclaw tui
```

- In the dialog box, enter **/agent** and press Enter to select the newly created agent

```

session agent:main:tui-ed9165f2-9747-401a-a003-4ec49571d5c9

new session: tui-ed9165f2-9747-401a-a003-4ec49571d5c9
connected | idle
agent main | session tui-ed9165f2-9747-401a-a003-4ec49571d5c9 | bailian/qwen3.6-plus | tokens ?/1.0m

/agent

```

→ agent	Switch agent (or open picker)
agents	Open agent picker
subagents	List, kill, log, spawn, or steer subagent runs for this session.

```
session agent:main:tui-ed9165f2-9747-401a-a003-4ec49571d5c9

new session: tui-ed9165f2-9747-401a-a003-4ec49571d5c9
connected | idle
agent main | session tui-ed9165f2-9747-401a-a003-4ec49571d5c9 | bailian/qwen3.6-plus | tokens ?/1.0m

search: >

main default
→ work (work)
```

- Enter text in the input box to converse with the agent

```
⚠️Note: The Move tool returned "fetch failed" earlier when I tried it manually. If the motion service is still down, the task may not execute the movement part successfully. The scheduled task will still attempt it each time.

Want me to:
- Stop the task?
- Modify the interval or actions?
- Run it now to test?

hello

Hey there! 🙋 What can I help you with?
connected | idle
agent main | session main (openclaw-tui) | bailian/qwen3.6-plus | tokens 14k/1.0m (1%)
```

4. Deleting Agents

4.1 Deleting with CLI Commands

For example, delete an agent named `work`:

```
openclaw agents delete work
```

```
◇ Delete agent "work" and prune workspace/state?
  Yes
Config overwrite: /home/jetson/.openclaw/openclaw.json (sha256 99fd93a1f06e53e77f20deecc6cc29fc2f7234a94c030919a80f391aea98af03 -> b58c20feb702579090f007c9bfe9a55a8978aa7d955e0f1b7075c4876b933d0, backup=/home/jetson/.openclaw/openclaw.json.bak)
Updated ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Failed to move to Trash (manual delete): ~/.openclaw/workspace-work
Failed to move to Trash (manual delete): ~/.openclaw/agents/work/sessions
Deleted agent: work
```

4.2 Manually Cleaning Up the Agent Directory

After running the CLI command, it is recommended to also clean up the following residual data:

```
# Delete the agent data directory
rm -rf ~/.openclaw/agents/<agentId>

# Delete the agent workspace
rm -rf ~/.openclaw/workspace-<agentId>
```

4.3 Cleaning Up Binding Configuration

After deleting an agent, you also need to remove the corresponding binding records and the agent list entries from the `openclaw.json` configuration file:

1. Open the configuration file: `~/.openclaw/openclaw.json`
2. Remove the corresponding agent entry from `agents.list`
3. Remove the binding rules related to this agent from `bindings`
4. Save and restart the gateway:

```
openclaw gateway restart
```